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ENGLISH LANGUAGE FORM FOUR

Certificate of Secondary Education Examination (CSEE) 2025 Answer Key and Worked Solutions

Subject	English Language
Code	022
Level	Form Four
Year	2025
Exam Board	NECTA
Exam	Certificate of Secondary Education Examination (CSEE)
Type	Answer key and worked solutions
Questions	11 questions; every Section C option solved; 59 answered parts

Try each question before checking the solution. Follow the steps, compare your working, and practise the parts you find difficult.

Source paper: English-F4-2025.pdf

All optional literature questions are answered for revision. Question 6(vii) admits a grammatical reading as printed; the intended simultaneous-progressive version is provided. Question 8 requires past forms in several blanks despite saying only say or tell.

Section A — Objective questions

1(i). Write another person's personal information.

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: A biography is written about someone else; an autobiography is written by its subject.

Final Answer: E — Biography.

1(ii). Identify a correct equal-height comparison.

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: Use as + adjective + as. The more formal full clause is I am as tall as he is.

Final Answer: A — I am as tall as him.

1(iii). Describe playing for five hours as a completed event.

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: Simple past treats the period as finished. If completion is directly linked to the present, I have played for five hours would also be natural, but it is absent from the options.

Final Answer: C — I played for five hours, the suitable completed-past option provided.

1(iv). Name cards expressing sympathy after a death.

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: Condolence means sympathy for a bereaved person.

Final Answer: B — Condolence cards.

1(v). Identify what a dictionary does not normally provide.

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: A dictionary supplies meanings, spelling, pronunciation and usage; its entries do not establish the complete size of a language.

Final Answer: D — The total number of words of a language.

1(vi). Explain Fidelis likes neither fish nor beef.

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: Neither ... nor excludes both choices.

Final Answer: E — Fidelis dislikes both fish and beef.

1(vii). Explain “He is always shouting at his wife.”

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: Always with the continuous form presents recurrent behaviour, often with disapproval; it does not mean a single action only at this instant.

Final Answer: C — Over a longer period of time.

1(viii). Identify the sentence without future reference.

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: It has no future-time expression or future form, unlike the other choices.

Final Answer: C — They read both documents.

1(ix). Define a paternal uncle.

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: Paternal refers to the father's side of the family.

Final Answer: B — The father's brother.

1(x). Why omit the writer's name from the sender's address in the taught formal-letter format?

Step 1: Compare the wording, meaning and grammatical form.

Step 2: The name identifies the writer below the closing and signature.

Final Answer: A — It normally appears at the bottom.

2(i). Match the modal expression: May I go out?

Step 1: Identify the function of the auxiliary in context; a letter may be used more than once.

Step 2: May requests permission.

Final Answer: D — Ask for permission.

2(ii). Match the modal expression: Can he play football?

Step 1: Identify the function of the auxiliary in context; a letter may be used more than once.

Step 2: Can asks about his capacity to play.

Final Answer: H — Express ability.

2(iii). Match the modal expression: He might be right.

Step 1: Identify the function of the auxiliary in context; a letter may be used more than once.

Step 2: Might gives a possibility rather than certainty.

Final Answer: G — Express uncertainty.

2(iv). Match the modal expression: I can solve the problem.

Step 1: Identify the function of the auxiliary in context; a letter may be used more than once.

Step 2: Can states capacity to solve it.

Final Answer: H — Express ability.

2(v). Match the modal expression: You must stay here.

Step 1: Identify the function of the auxiliary in context; a letter may be used more than once.

Step 2: Must requires the action.

Final Answer: C — Express obligation.

2(vi). Match the modal expression: I will die for my country.

Step 1: Identify the function of the auxiliary in context; a letter may be used more than once.

Step 2: Will here conveys resolve or willingness.

Final Answer: A — Express determination.

Section Summary: Choose biography when someone else writes the life account. Modals express permission, ability, uncertainty, obligation or resolve according to context.

Section B — Language use

3. Rearrange the marathon sentences A-F into a coherent paragraph.

Step 1: Start with selection F and the reaction to that information C.

Step 2: Continue with arrival on the race day B, then lining up and starting A.

Step 3: Place the ongoing race E before its surprising finish D.

Final Answer: 1-6: F, C, B, A, E, D.

One day, my name was mentioned to participate in the international marathon. My heart started beating after that information since it was my first time. The day came, and we all gathered for the event. Then, we were called to line up and allowed to start. While we were running, the spectators were shouting, but I did not hear my name. Surprisingly, I was the first person to touch the finishing line.

4(i). Complete the invitation field: Invitee's name.

Step 1: Match the field's purpose with the supplied words.

Step 2: The salutation is Miss Rose.

Final Answer: Rose

4(ii). Complete the invitation field: Event type.

Step 1: Match the field's purpose with the supplied words.

Step 2: The heading and Paul's celebration identify a birthday, not a wedding.

Final Answer: Birthday party

4(iii). Complete the invitation field: Venue.

Step 1: Match the field's purpose with the supplied words.

Step 2: A hall name supplies the location.

Final Answer: Green Star Hall

4(iv). Complete the invitation field: Time.

Step 1: Match the field's purpose with the supplied words.

Step 2: The supplied period belongs after the time phrase, even though starting from is awkward before an ending time.

Final Answer: 4:30 p.m. to 10:30 p.m.

4(v). Complete the invitation field: Reply heading.

Step 1: Match the field's purpose with the supplied words.

Step 2: This introduces the request and details for replying.

Final Answer: RSVP

4(vi). Complete the invitation field: Mrs Majengo's contact.

Step 1: Match the field's purpose with the supplied words.

Step 2: Use the provided telephone digits without inventing new contact information.

Final Answer: Mobile Number 0711000543

5(i). Construct a descriptive sentence using Round.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: Round describes shape.

Final Answer: The table is round.

5(ii). Construct a descriptive sentence using Black.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: Black describes colour.

Final Answer: The bag is black.

5(iii). Construct a descriptive sentence using Energetic.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: Energetic describes vigour.

Final Answer: The athlete is energetic.

5(iv). Construct a descriptive sentence using Pretty.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: Pretty describes pleasing appearance.

Final Answer: The garden is pretty.

5(v). Construct a descriptive sentence using Tall.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: Tall describes height.

Final Answer: The tree is tall.

5(vi). Construct a descriptive sentence using Attractive.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: Attractive modifies entrance.

Final Answer: The building has an attractive entrance.

5(vii). Construct a descriptive sentence using Shapeless.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: Shapeless describes an indistinct shape.

Final Answer: The melted wax formed a shapeless lump.

5(viii). Construct a descriptive sentence using Kind.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: Kind describes considerate behaviour.

Final Answer: Our neighbour is kind.

5(ix). Construct a descriptive sentence using New.

Step 1: Use a complete sentence in which the supplied adjective describes a person or object.

Step 2: New describes the bicycle's condition or age.

Final Answer: She bought a new bicycle.

6(i). Correct the sentence: The students were playing soccer yesterday. Aren't they.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: Match past were with negative weren't in the tag, retain plural they and use a question mark.

Final Answer: The students were playing soccer yesterday, weren't they?

6(ii). Correct the sentence: Although the headmaster offered the trip to Ngorongoro but the student refused to go.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: Do not combine although and but for the same concessive link; remove but.

Final Answer: Although the headmaster offered the trip to Ngorongoro, the student refused to go.

6(iii). Correct the sentence: You can see I am busy right now. Do not west my time.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: Waste means use time unproductively; west names a direction.

Final Answer: You can see I am busy right now. Do not waste my time.

6(iv). Correct the sentence: I must go to the farm despite of the rain.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: Despite takes a noun phrase without of. In spite of is an alternative.

Final Answer: I must go to the farm despite the rain.

6(v). Correct the sentence: That is the man which came here yesterday.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: Who refers to a person; that is also possible in this defining clause.

Final Answer: That is the man who came here yesterday.

6(vi). Correct the sentence: My friend is to weak too run 15 km.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: Use too + adjective + to-infinitive.

Final Answer: My friend is too weak to run 15 km.

6(vii). Correct the sentence: My sister was singing while I danced.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: This is the likely intended correction for two simultaneous ongoing actions. The original can also be grammatical if danced presents the other activity as a whole.

Final Answer: My sister was singing while I was dancing.

6(viii). Correct the sentence: We planned to travel on ship.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: By ship names a means of transport; on a ship is also grammatical with an article.

Final Answer: We planned to travel by ship.

6(ix). Correct the sentence: I usually sleep on bed.

Step 1: Identify the particular spelling, connector, tense, relative pronoun or preposition issue.

Step 2: In bed is the normal expression for sleeping; on a bed requires an article and refers more literally to its surface.

Final Answer: I usually sleep in bed.

7(i). Construct a sentence with both ... and.

Step 1: Put parallel words or clauses on the two sides of the paired construction.

Step 2: The paired subject takes plural enjoy.

Final Answer: Both Asha and Juma enjoy reading.

7(ii). Construct a sentence with neither ... nor.

Step 1: Put parallel words or clauses on the two sides of the paired construction.

Step 2: The two alternatives are both excluded.

Final Answer: Neither tea nor coffee is available.

7(iii). Construct a sentence with either ... or.

Step 1: Put parallel words or clauses on the two sides of the paired construction.

Step 2: The structure offers alternatives.

Final Answer: You may choose either rice or potatoes.

7(iv). Construct a sentence with not only ... but also.

Step 1: Put parallel words or clauses on the two sides of the paired construction.

Step 2: The paired complements are parallel adjectives.

Final Answer: She is not only intelligent but also hardworking.

7(v). Construct a sentence with prefer ... to.

Step 1: Put parallel words or clauses on the two sides of the paired construction.

Step 2: Use parallel -ing forms and to, not than.

Final Answer: I prefer reading to watching television.

7(vi). Construct a sentence with whether ... or.

Step 1: Put parallel words or clauses on the two sides of the paired construction.

Step 2: The structure introduces two possible decisions.

Final Answer: Tell me whether you will walk or take the bus.

8(i). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: Ali ___ goodbye to me and left.

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: Say goodbye to someone; use past said to match left.

Final Answer: said

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

8(ii). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: Please ___ us about your holiday.

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: Tell takes the person us directly.

Final Answer: tell

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

8(iii). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: Don't just stand there! ___ something.

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: Say takes the spoken content something.

Final Answer: Say

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

8(iv). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: Please ___ everyone about our journey.

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: Everyone is the person-object of tell.

Final Answer: tell

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

8(v). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: Fatuma ___ me that he was fed up with his job.

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: Tell takes me directly and becomes told in past time. He can refer to a third person; the task does not establish otherwise.

Final Answer: told

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

8(vi). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: Never ___ it again!

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: It is the content spoken; there is no person-object requiring tell.

Final Answer: say

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

8(vii). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: Don't ___ anybody what you have seen.

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: Anybody is the listener-object.

Final Answer: tell

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

8(viii). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: Did she ___ you what happened?

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: After did, use the base form tell.

Final Answer: tell

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

8(ix). Complete with the correct form of say or tell: My sister couldn't help. She ___ me to ask Janeth.

Step 1: Look for a directly named listener and check the time or auxiliary.

Step 2: Tell someone to do something becomes told me to ask in the past.

Final Answer: told

Study Tip: The instruction says say or tell, but sentences in past time require their inflected forms said or told.

Section Summary: Rearrange events by cause and time. Keep paired conjunctions parallel. Tell normally takes a person directly, whereas say commonly takes words or a message.

Section C — Literature

9. Show how poetic language differs from ordinary conversation, giving three points from each of two poems.

Step 1: Select two prescribed poems and three distinct language features in each.

Step 2: Use accurate descriptions of the refrain, sound patterns, title, meal imagery and ironic contrasts.

Step 3: Explain the effect of each feature; avoid claiming that ordinary speech can never contain imagery or repetition.

Final Answer: Model response:

Poetic language can compress experience through patterns, images and irony. *A Freedom Song* by Marjorie Oludhe Macgoye and *Building the Nation* by Henry Barlow show these features while remaining understandable.

In *A Freedom Song*, the recurring address to Atieno acts as a refrain. Its return gives the poem a songlike pattern and keeps the girl's situation before the reader. This organised recurrence differs from an ordinary spontaneous conversation. Sound patterning also helps bind its lines together: related ending sounds connect observations about work and reward. The pattern makes unequal treatment memorable rather than presenting it only as a factual statement. A third feature is the ironic association of freedom with the young worker's restricted life. The title and the child's exploitation pull in opposite directions, requiring the reader to question whose freedom is being celebrated.

In *Building the Nation*, the speaker repeatedly relates everyday events to the patriotic idea of nation building. This deliberate verbal pattern links unequal experiences under one public slogan. The poem also uses vivid bodily and meal imagery. The official's abundant hospitality is placed beside the driver's hunger, making class inequality visible through physical experience. Finally, irony exposes the difference between public duty and private enjoyment. The official's account presents privilege as national service, while the driver's experience encourages readers to judge that claim critically.

Both poems therefore arrange language to do more than communicate literal information. Refrain, patterned sounds, images and irony lead readers to hear contrasts and infer criticism that would require a longer explanation in ordinary conversation.

10. Show liberated, conscious minds in African society, with three points from each of two plays.

Step 1: Identify consciousness through ideas and actions, not simply through education or wealth.

Step 2: Develop three examples per play and connect each with questioning injustice, choosing independently or organising action.

Step 3: Acknowledge that insight and success are different: the Stranger's awareness does not guarantee a successful resistance.

Final Answer: Model response:

A liberated mind questions unfair authority and acts with awareness of human dignity. Three Suitors: One Husband by Guillaume Oyono Mbia and This Time Tomorrow by Ngugi wa Thiong'o portray such thinking, even when circumstances limit its success.

In Three Suitors: One Husband, Juliette recognises that marriage concerns her own future. Her refusal to accept the elders' choice challenges the assumption that a daughter should be exchanged for the most rewarding payment. She also values education and her relationship with Oko above a suitor's wealth or official status. This judgement separates personal worth from prestige and demonstrates independence of thought. Third, her practical plan turns the bride-price system against those using it to control her. The outcome shows ingenuity in confronting a restrictive custom, rather than passive acceptance of the family's demands.

In This Time Tomorrow, the Stranger recognises that isolated poor residents have little power against the demolition plan. His appeal for collective action shows awareness of the structural nature of their problem. He also urges the residents to overcome fear and accept responsibility for defending their interests. This challenges resignation as the only response to poverty.

Njango's questioning of official treatment provides a third form of consciousness. Her insistence that the settlement represents a livelihood, rather than merely a nuisance, exposes the human cost hidden in bureaucratic plans.

The plays do not suggest that independent thinking automatically removes every obstacle. They show people identifying injustice, questioning accepted authority and seeking ways to act. Such awareness is an important resource for social change.

11. Explain why mistreatment upsets people, with three points from each of two novels.

Step 1: Choose two novels and identify three specific harmful acts or pressures in each.

Step 2: For every point, describe the affected person and explain the emotional consequence.

Step 3: Treat violence and coercion as the wrongdoer's responsibility; do not blame the person harmed.

Final Answer: Model response:

Mistreatment disregards another person's dignity and leaves emotional harm as well as practical consequences. Passed Like a Shadow by B. M. Mapalala and Unanswered Cries by Osman Conteh illustrate the effects within families and personal relationships.

In Passed Like a Shadow, Adyeri's violent treatment of Amoti turns disagreement into fear and humiliation. His conduct makes the home an unsafe place rather than a source of care. His treatment of Vicky's wish to marry Akena is another example. The demand for an excessive bride price makes her preference subordinate to financial gain, causing frustration and disappointment. John's assault on Abooki after exploiting her trust provides a third case. It violates her consent and creates distress precisely because she had expected safety from someone she trusted.

In Unanswered Cries, Makalay's pressure to subject Olabisi to cutting causes fear and resistance. The girl's own wishes are disregarded, showing why coercion is harmful even when adults claim that a custom is beneficial. Social condemnation of an uncircumcised girl adds a second source of mistreatment. The threat of rejection tries to force conformity through shame and undermines a young person's sense of belonging. Eddy's damaging reversal in court is a third example. It leaves Olabisi disappointed by a person whose support she expected and reveals how dishonesty can intensify a vulnerable person's anxiety.

Both novels connect mistreatment with broken security and loss of trust. Respectful family relationships, freedom from coercion and honest support would protect people from the fear, shame and disappointment portrayed in these works.

Section Summary: Explain what a poetic device achieves. Literature essays need three distinct developed points from each of two prescribed works, with evidence and a link to the exact claim.

Source Checks

NECTA English CSEE 2024 — prescribed-novel event checks

Building the Nation — Rwanda Education Board English reader